The two weeks at Annisquam were highly successful. We met nice people, saw pleasant shows, took various ocean and land trips to Gloucester, Rockport, Marblehead, Wingershaek Beach, and so on.

What I remember most clearly, though, was my co-operation with the waiters who were trying to write parodies of the songs in popular musicals; parodies that would have local significance.

They were having trouble, and knowing me to be a writer, they asked my advice. I looked over what they had done and said, "No, no, you've got to match the original lyrics, syllable by syllable, stress by stress, and rhyme by rhyme, or the music won't fit and the whole thing won't sound clever. For heaven's sake, don't try to improve on Cole Porter."

"What do you mean?" they asked humbly.

'Til show you," I said. "You're working with Kiss Me, Kate, so let's start with 'Wunderbar: "

After a while, I wrote:

Annisquam, Annisquam We've taken ocean trips But when the sea ain't calm Take the train to Annisquam.

"Sing it!" I said.

They did and they were delighted with the way in which the syllables slid into the music.

They insisted I go on to the other songs and contented themselves with observation. I worked away matching syllables and keeping all the internal rhymes. I said, for instance, "Such tender slips make slender tips increase," and "Could she fill with prattle still the cattle boat to Salem," and, "We broke all the laws upon the shores of Wingershaek."

Then I had to attend all the rehearsals to make sure that they sang the songs correctly, and I took the lead baritone part myself. What it amounted to was that I spent a major part of the vacation indoors working.

Gertrude pointed out the folly of paying premium vacation rates and then spending the time working for the management.

I tried to explain to her that the shoe was on the other foot; that I was enjoying